Humana. Claims Payment Policy

Subject: Modifier 22

Application: Medicare Advantage Products
Policy number: CP2006101
Related policies: Common CPT and HCPCS Modifiers

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Overview

This policy outlines Humana's billing requirements and reimbursement for *modifier 22*.

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Medicare Advantage Payment Policy

In addition to the policy, claims payments are subject to other plan requirements for the processing and payment of claims, including, but not limited to, requirements of medical necessity and reasonableness and applicable referral or authorization requirements.

The following applies to professional services only.

Modifier 22 may be added to a procedure code to indicate that the work required to provide a service was substantially greater than is typically required. Documentation must support the substantial additional work and the reason for the additional work. Examples of circumstances that might require substantial additional work for which it is appropriate to report *modifier 22* include increased intensity, time or technical difficulty of the service; increased severity of the patient's condition; and increased physical or mental effort required to provide the service. Additional service time alone does not justify the use of *modifier 22*. *Modifier 22* should be reported only with a procedure code that has a global surgery period of 0, 10 or 90 days. *Modifier 22* should not be appended to an evaluation and management (E/M) service.

Humana determines additional reimbursement, if any, for a procedure code submitted with *modifier 22*, based on individual consideration of unusual circumstances as documented in the medical record or operative report. Humana does not allow more than the billed charge amount for a procedure code submitted with *modifier 22*.

Definitions of *Italicized* Terms

- ***Modifier 22:*** Increased procedural services

References

- Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services website. Medicare Claims Processing Manual. Chapter 12 – Physicians/Nonphysician Practitioners. Sections 20.4.6, 40.2 and 40.4. www.cms.gov.
- Wisconsin Physicians Services website. Jurisdictions 5 and 8 MAC. Modifier 22 Fact Sheet. www.wpsgha.com.
- CGS Administrators website. Jurisdiction J15 MAC. Modifier 22: Increased/Unusual Procedural Services. www.csgmedicare.com.
- American Medical Association's CPT® and associated publications and services.

General Humana Resources

- Availity – Providers can register for access to information on a variety of topics such as eligibility, benefits, referrals, authorizations, claims and electronic remittances.
- Claims processing edit notifications – Alerts of upcoming claims payment changes are posted on the first Friday of each month.
- Claims resources – Providers can find information on referrals, authorizations, electronic claim submissions and more.
- Making it easier – This page contains an educational series for providers and healthcare professionals.
- Medical and pharmacy coverage policies – Humana publishes determinations of coverage of medical procedures, devices and medications for the treatment of various conditions. There may be variances in coverage among plans.
- Publications – This page can help you find our quarterly newsletter, provider manual and other resources to help you do business with us.

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